

Stanford | Department of Economics

SCHOOL OF HUMANITIES AND SCIENCES

February 20, 2026

Dear Michael,

The Faculty Committee of Admissions in the Department of Economics at Stanford University has thoroughly reviewed your application. I am sorry to inform you that the committee did not recommend you for admission.

We regret that we could not accept all the exceptional students who applied to our department. The selection process was difficult and painstaking, and many strong candidates had to be turned away.

Answers to Frequently Asked Questions

We appreciate your interest in the Stanford University Economics PhD Program. Below are answers to some questions that you may have about the selection process.

Q: Can you tell me why I wasn't selected for the Economics PhD Program?

A: We are humbled each year by the large number of extraordinary applications to our program, which means that many candidates with impressive achievements and strong potential are not selected each year.

Q: Will you name a group of alternates?

A: Yes. We monitor a short list of waitlisted applicants and have made those determinations in the admissions process.

Q: May I receive feedback on my application?

A: Regretfully, no. Applicants who are not selected sometimes assume that there are deficiencies or faults in their applications. This is rarely the case. The reasons why some applicants stand out more than others are not easily categorized since excellence itself does not come in uniform dimensions.

Q: Is there an appeal process?

A: No. The committee's decisions are final each year.

Q: May I reapply to the Economics program in the future?

A: Of course! We will welcome new applications in future application cycles. The next cycle will open in September 2026, with a deadline in late November for the entry class of academic year 2027-2028.

I wish you the greatest success in the future.

Sincerely yours,



Liran Einav
Chair, Department of Economics
Charles R. Schwab Professor of Economics